

City University of Hong Kong

Information on a Course offered by Department of Accountancy with effect from Semester A in 2014 / 2015

Part I

Course Title: Advanced Management Accounting

Course Code: AC4322

Course Duration: 1 semester

Credit Units: 3

Level: B4

Medium of Instruction: English

Prerequisites: AC4321 Management Accounting

Precursors: Nil

Equivalent Courses: Nil

Exclusive Courses: Nil

Part II

Course Aims

This course aims to:

1. integrate knowledge from different topics in AC4321 Management Accounting and other related prior courses in order to help students solve complex real-life business problems;
2. help students develop skills in performing analysis and reporting, both orally and in written form, by using real-life cases in management accounting. The target standard is at a level comparable to professional bodies' (e.g. HKICPA, ICMA, CMA, etc.) examination requirements for the relevant modules;
3. demonstrate the interaction between business strategy and internal control through critical evaluation of complex real-life cases dealing with management control systems and strategic cost management. This interaction is examined in an international setting.

Course Intended Learning Outcomes (CILOs)

Upon successful completion of this course, students should be able to:

Note: The weights for each CILO will be set by the course examiner at her/his discretion.

No.	CILOs	Linkage to Aims	DEC-related dimension
1.	Analyze complex problems in management control systems (MCS) and strategic cost management (SCM) drawn from case studies of large organizations, design solutions to these problems, and critically evaluate possible solutions suggested by others. This is done in an international setting. Topics to be discussed include management control environment (e.g. responsibility centers), management control process (e.g. strategic planning, performance measurement) and selected advanced management topics.	1,2,3	Attitude; Ability.
2.	Effectively communicate understanding of complex issues in cases in MCS and SCM in presenting to an audience, in debating within a small group, and in writing case analysis.	2	Attitude; Ability.
3.	Design internal control systems that match a company's competitive strategy, and critically evaluate the fit between a company's existing or proposed controls and its strategy; Demonstrate and apply ethical concepts in selected management control situations.	1,3	Attitude; Ability.

Teaching and Learning Activities (TLAs)

(Indicative of likely activities and tasks designed to facilitate students' achievement of the CILOs. Final details will be provided to students in their first week of attendance in this course)

CILO No.	TLAs	Hours/week (if applicable)
CILO 1-3	<u>TLA1:</u> Case Analysis is the most important activity in this class. * The lecturer will play a facilitating role that may involve: ● setting the agenda for class discussion; ● setting questions to be discussed in class; ● summarizing points raised by students; ● evaluating student participation; ● moderating group discussions and open class discussions if necessary; and ● briefly introducing the case or relevant background subject-matter through short mini-lectures. Student activities related to case analysis may include the following components weighted as follows: <u>*DEC TLA element</u>	3
CILO 1-3	TLA 1.1: Open class discussion * *DEC TLA element	0-45 mins.
CILO 1-3	TLA 1.2: Group discussion * *DEC TLA element	0-45 mins.
CILO 1-3	TLA 1.3: Oral Presentation * *DEC TLA element	0-45 mins.
CILO 1-3	TLA 1.4: Written Reports * *DEC TLA element	0-45 mins (outside class)
CILO 1-3	TLA 1.5: Role plays * *DEC TLA element	0-45 mins.

Assessment Tasks/Activities

(Indicative of likely activities and tasks designed to assess how well the students achieve the CILOs. Final details will be provided to students in their first week of attendance in this course)

Examination: 50% (a 3-hour examination)

AT1 Final Examination (50%): A final examination will typically be open-book open-notes (but at examiner's discretion). The scope could include a new case, assigned specially for the examination, or it could include cases examined earlier, but raising questions that were not discussed in class or through earlier reports or tests.

In addition, management accounting concepts and theories covered in the course will also be tested (CILO 1-3).

Coursework: 50%

AT2: Individual case analysis written reports (10% - 20%)*

AT3: Group Presentations (10% - 20%)*

AT4: Participation including in-class and outside classroom (10% - 20%)

AT5: Mid-term Test (0% - 20%)

* DEC AT element

Note:

On the actual course outline issued to students, a definite % for each AT will be specified, total will add up to 100%.

Students are required to pass both coursework and examination components in order to pass the course.

Grading of Student Achievement: Also refer to Grading of Courses in the Academic Regulations.

CILO No.	Excellent (A+, A, A-)	Good (B+, B, B-)	Adequate (C+, C, C-)	Marginal (D)
CILO1	Demonstrates Excellent Business Judgment in analysing complex management accounting problems, suggesting solutions and critically evaluating proposed solutions.	Demonstrates Sound Business Judgment in analysing complex management accounting problems, suggesting solutions and critically evaluating proposed solutions.	Demonstrates Adequate Business Judgment in analysing complex management accounting problems, suggesting solutions and critically evaluating proposed solutions.	Demonstrates Some Business Judgment in analysing complex management accounting problems, suggesting solutions and critically evaluating proposed solutions.

CILO No.	Excellent (A+, A, A-)	Good (B+, B, B-)	Adequate (C+, C, C-)	Marginal (D)
CILO2	Able to Easily and Fluently Present complex management accounting ideas in all three ways: presentation, group discussions, and written reports; with a consistently high level of understanding and retention by the target audience.	Able to Present complex management accounting ideas Reasonably Well in all three ways: presentation, group discussions, and written reports; with a high level of understanding and retention by most of the target audience most of the time.	Able to Adequately Present complex management accounting ideas in all three ways: presentation, group discussions, and written reports; with an adequate level of understanding and retention by most of the target audience most of the time.	Able to Sometimes Present complex management accounting ideas Acceptably in at least two of three ways: presentation, group discussions, and written reports; with an adequate level of understanding and retention by at least some of the target audience some of the time.
CILO3	Demonstrates Excellent Strategic Thinking in designing internal control systems that match a company's competitive strategy, and critically evaluating the fit between a company's existing or proposed controls and its strategy; Able to demonstrate and apply ethical concepts in all of the selected management control situations.	Demonstrates Sound Strategic Thinking in designing internal control systems that match a company's competitive strategy, and critically evaluating the fit between a company's existing or proposed controls and its strategy. Able to demonstrate and apply ethical concepts in most of the selected management control situations.	Demonstrates Adequate Strategic Thinking in designing internal control systems that match a company's competitive strategy, and critically evaluating the fit between a company's existing or proposed controls and its strategy. Able to demonstrate and apply ethical concepts in some of the selected management control situations.	Demonstrates Some Strategic Thinking in designing internal control systems that match a company's competitive strategy, and critically evaluating the fit between a company's existing or proposed controls and its strategy. Able to demonstrate and apply ethical concepts in a few of the selected management control situations.

Part III

Keyword Syllabus

Information needs for strategic management. Accounting for organizational control. Behavioral aspects of management control. The use of non-financial performance measures. Management control systems.

Recommended Reading

Text(s)

1. Anthony, R.N. and Govindarajan, V., Management Control Systems (McGraw-Hill: latest edition)
2. Merchant, K.A. and Van der Stede, N.A., Management Control Systems (Prentice Hall: latest edition)
3. Kaplan, R.S. and Atkinson, A.A., Advanced Management Accounting (Prentice Hall: latest edition)
4. O'Connor, N.G., Management Control of Multinational Enterprises in China (McGraw-Hill: Latest Edition)
5. Shank, J.K., Cases in Cost Management: A Strategic Emphasis (Thomson: latest edition)
6. Cooper, R. and Kaplan, R.S., The Design of Cost Management Systems (Prentice Hall: latest edition)
7. Cases from the HKICPA QP, IMA and others (with permission).

Online Resources

1. Blackboard site for the course.
2. The Management Accounting Web: <http://www.maaw.info/>
3. The Chartered Institute of Management Accountants (CIMA) – UK. www.cimaglobal.com
4. Certified Management Accountants (CMA) – Canada. www.cma-canada.org
5. Institute of Management Accountants (IMA) – USA. www.imanet.org